Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform role at Halden Pay. I bring 9 years of experience building and operating data platforms across logistics and payments, with hands-on work in Python, SQL, Airflow, dbt, Kafka and cloud data warehouses. The role's focus on a shared platform and reusable frameworks closely matches the work I have led at Lukovac Freight Hub.

I own ingestion and orchestration for a platform with about 140 Airflow DAGs, and migrated around 300 stored procedures into more than 420 tested dbt models. That work reduced the nightly warehouse build from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes. I have also introduced JSON Schema data contracts and CI checks with product teams, reducing broken-pipeline incidents, and built Kafka streaming and Debezium CDC pipelines for production data workloads.

My payments experience is also directly relevant: at Kovalent Pay I built PySpark reconciliation jobs on AWS EMR, designed a dimensional Redshift warehouse for finance and risk, and added data quality checks to critical finance tables. This experience gives me a solid foundation with a comparable cloud and warehouse stack, alongside practical experience improving platform reliability, performance and cost. I also contribute to open-source Airflow work and have presented on data contracts at a regional data meetup.

Halden Pay's emphasis on ownership and reducing unnecessary complexity is reflected in the way I approach data engineering: build dependable systems, make quality expectations explicit, and keep pipelines maintainable. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my platform and payments experience could contribute to the Data Platform team.

Kind regards,
Lena Varga-Holm